

Chapter 5

Groups and Managing Teamwork

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1

Define groups and stages of group development.

2

Understand Conflict management

3

Analyze types of Conflicts at workplace

4

Talents Grid to assess and manage employees in organizations

Group

Group

- Two or more interacting and interdependent individuals who come together to achieve specific goals.

Types:

Formal: Defined by organizational structure, with assigned tasks and responsibilities geared towards organizational goals.

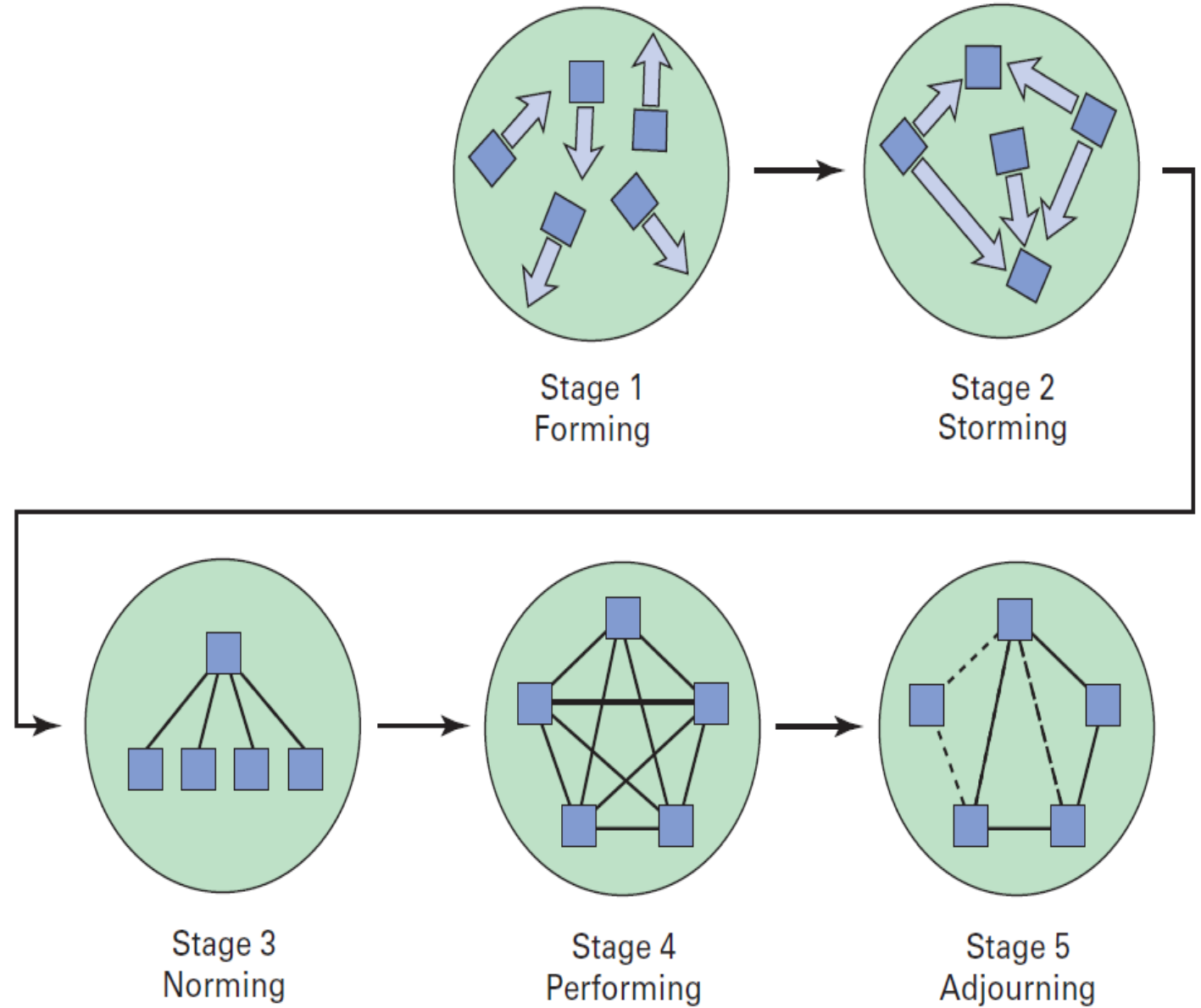
Examples: Committees, project teams.

Informal: Develop naturally based on social connections and shared interests.

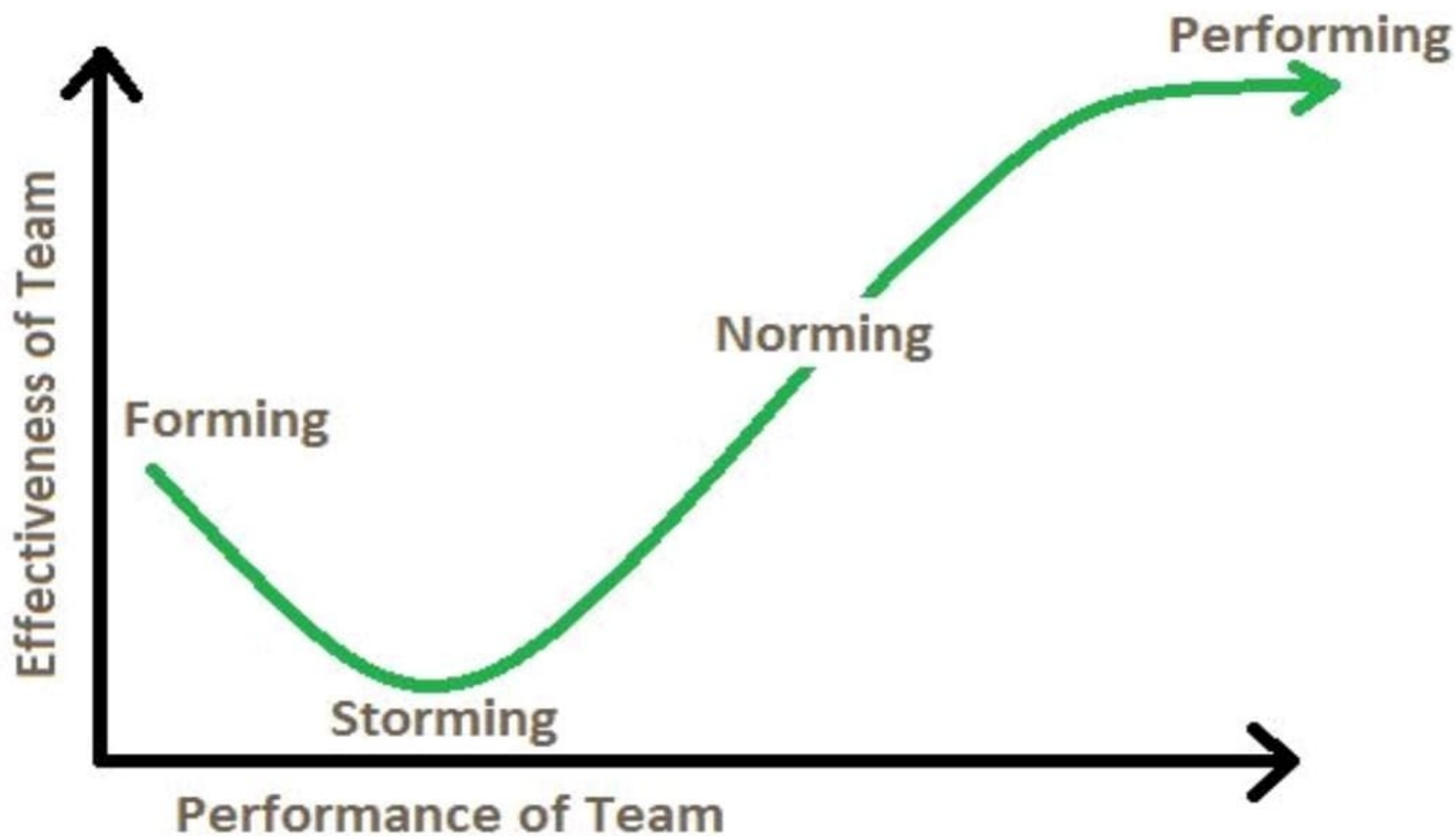
Example: A lunch group of employees from different departments.



Stages of Group Development



Tuckman's Team & Group Development Model



Stage 1 Forming

The **forming stage** is the initial phase of group development where members come together for the first time.

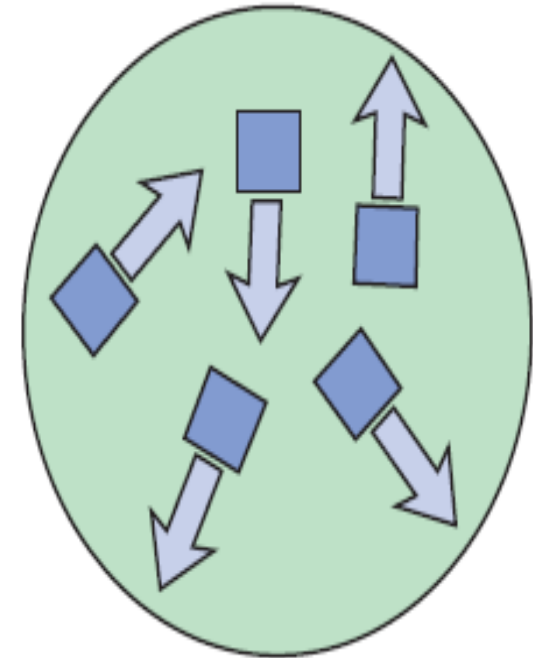
This stage is **characterized** by:

- Uncertainty and ambiguity about the group's purpose, structure, and leadership.
- Members are cautious and polite as they try to understand their roles, the expectations of the group, and each other.

Key features of the forming stage include:

- 1.Goal Setting:** Establishing clear objectives for the group.
- 2.Role Definition:** Assigning roles and responsibilities to team members.
- 3.Relationship Building:** Encouraging initial social interactions to build trust and cooperation.
- 4.Procedural Framework:** Setting the rules and processes for decision-making and communication.

The stage is considered complete when members start to see themselves as part of a cohesive group.



Stage 1
Forming

Stage 1 Forming

Example:

A company forms a cross-functional team to launch a new product. The team includes members from marketing, R&D, sales, and customer service. Initially, the team members are unfamiliar with each other and uncertain about how their efforts will align.

Team Leader Role in the Forming Stage

1. Initiating Team-Building Activities:

- Conducting workshops, ice-breaker sessions, or team lunches to build rapport.
- Facilitating discussions that allow members to share their backgrounds, skills, and expectations.

2. Clarifying Goals and Expectations:

- Clearly defining the team's objectives and desired outcomes.
- Ensuring every member understands their role and how it contributes to the team's success.

3. Encouraging Open Communication:

- Creating a safe space for members to express concerns or ask questions.
- Setting up tools and channels for collaboration (e.g., project management software, WhatsApp group).

4. Building Trust and Cooperation:

- Modeling cooperative behavior by actively listening and showing empathy.
- Reinforcing the importance of collaboration over individual agendas.

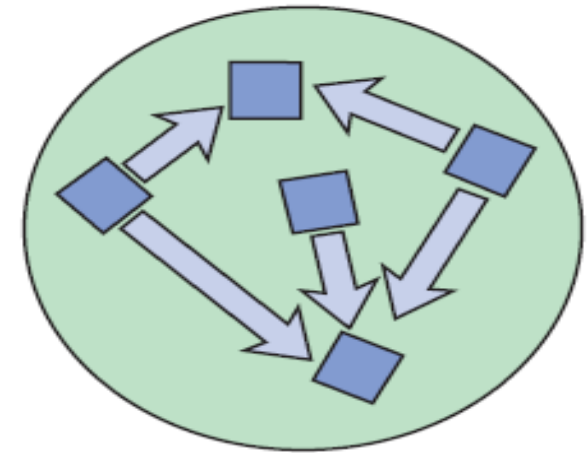
Stage 2 Storming

The **storming stage** is a challenging phase in team development where conflicts and disagreements are likely to arise.

Key characteristics of the storming stage:

- 1.Conflicts and Tensions:** Disputes about leadership, roles, and goals are common.
- 2.Resistance and Frustration:** Members may feel discouraged if progress is slow or goals seem unattainable.
- 3.Role Negotiation:** Members strive to establish their position and influence within the team.

This stage is crucial for the group to work through conflicts and lay the foundation for trust, collaboration, and shared understanding.



Stage 2
Storming

Stage 2 Storming

Example:

A marketing team is tasked with creating a campaign for a new product launch. During brainstorming sessions, tensions arise:

- The creative team insists on an innovative but risky concept.
- The analytics team pushes for a data-driven, conservative approach.
- Members argue about timelines and responsibilities.

Team Leader Role in the Storming Stage

1.Creating a Safe Space for Expression:

- Encouraging team members to openly share their concerns and frustrations without fear of judgment.

2.Promoting Constructive Conflict Resolution:

- Guiding the team to approach disagreements as problem-solving opportunities.
- Mediating heated discussions and refocusing the team on shared goals.

3.Facilitating Harmony and Common Ground:

- Helping members align their diverse perspectives toward mutually agreed-upon goals.

4.Maintaining Team Morale:

- Reinforcing the importance of working through conflicts to achieve team success.
- Offering individual support to team members who feel overwhelmed.

Stage 3 Norming

The **norming stage** marks a transition from conflict to cohesion.

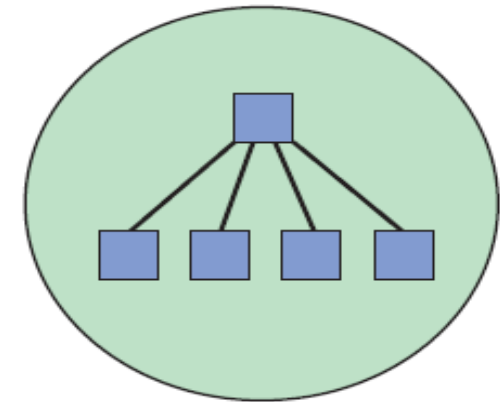
Members begin to accept one another and their assigned roles within the team.

Key characteristics of the norming stage:

- 1.Acceptance and Alignment:** Members accept each other's strengths and agree on roles and responsibilities.
- 2.Cooperation and Trust:** Relationships improve as trust and respect grow.
- 3.Establishing Norms:** The team develops shared guidelines and workflows for effective collaboration.

Norming Stage Indicators:

- The team conducts regular meetings with clear agendas and productive outcomes.
- Members take ownership of their tasks and deliver on deadlines.
- Collaboration and knowledge-sharing improve, leading to steady progress.



Stage 3
Norming

Stage 3 Norming

Example

A start-up forms a team to develop a mobile app. After overcoming the storming stage's conflicts (e.g., differing priorities and miscommunication), the team begins to settle into their roles:

- The UI/UX designer aligns their design with the developer's technical requirements.
- The marketing lead collaborates with the team to prepare for a smooth launch.
- Team members establish workflows, such as using project management software to track progress.

Team Leader Role in the Norming Stage

1.Facilitating Development of Norms:

- Helping the team define clear guidelines, best practices, and workflows.
- Ensuring everyone is aligned on expectations and work standards.

2.Clarifying Roles and Responsibilities:

- Verifying that all team members understand their tasks and contributions to the team's goals.
- Addressing any remaining ambiguities to maintain alignment and reduce confusion.

3.Encouraging Accountability and Mutual Support:

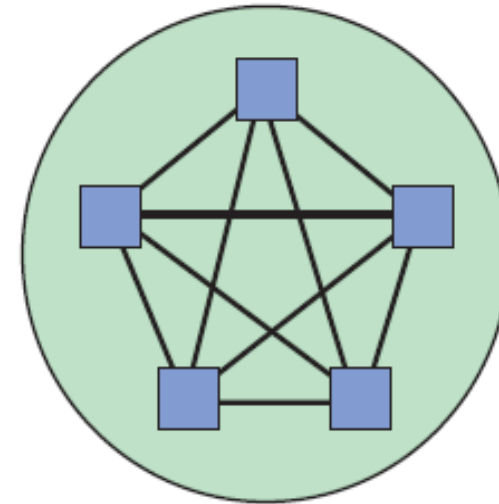
- Promoting a culture where team members hold themselves and each other accountable for their responsibilities.
- Celebrating small successes and fostering an environment of encouragement and positivity.

Stage 4 Performing

The **performing stage** is when the team reaches its peak functionality. Members have fully embraced their roles and are focused on achieving the shared goals.

- **Key characteristics** of the **performing** stage:

- **Role Mastery:** Members understand their roles and deliver with minimal supervision.
- **High Collaboration:** Teams function as a cohesive unit, prioritizing collective success over individual agendas.
- **Goal Achievement:** The primary focus is on completing tasks, meeting objectives, and delivering results.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Members actively seek ways to innovate, solve problems, and enhance productivity.



Stage 4
Performing

Stage 4 Performing

Example:

A marketing team at a multinational corporation is tasked with launching a global advertising campaign. Having established clear goals, resolved conflicts, and solidified roles in earlier stages, the team now focuses on execution:

- The creative team designs innovative ad content.
- The digital marketing team optimizes online ad placements.
- The analytics team monitors campaign performance in real-time and adjusts strategies as needed.

Team Leader Role in the Performing Stage

1.Guiding and Coaching:

- Acting as an advisor to help team members overcome challenges or refine their approaches.
- Providing mentorship to develop skills and confidence further.

2.Monitoring Progress and Offering Feedback:

- Tracking milestones and ensuring the team stays aligned with objectives.
- Offering constructive feedback and recognizing achievements to motivate and engage the team.

3.Ensuring Fairness and Equitable Workload:

- Regularly reviewing task distribution to prevent overburdening any member.
- Encouraging mutual support and maintaining harmony within the team.

4.Fostering Continuous Improvement:

- Facilitating post-project reviews to assess performance and identify lessons learned.

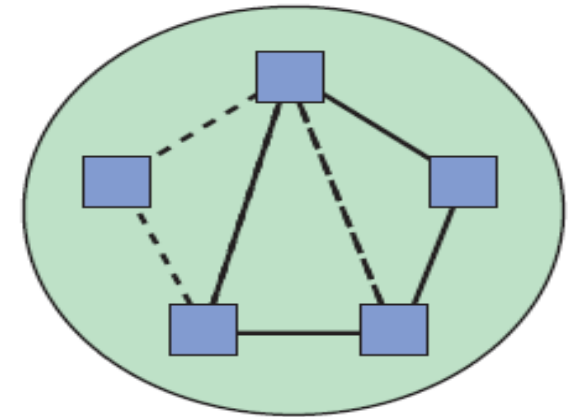
Stage 5 Adjourning

The **adjourning stage** occurs as the team approaches the end of its project or assignment.

- This phase focuses on closure the group and wrapping up activities.
- The mood can vary: team members may feel a sense of accomplishment, nostalgia, or even disappointment if the project was unsuccessful.
- This stage is vital for evaluating the team's performance, documenting lessons learned, and ensuring a smooth transition for members..

Key characteristics of the adjourning stage:

- 1.Task Completion:** Final deliverables are prepared, presented, or implemented.
- 2.Reflection:** The team reflects on successes, challenges, and lessons learned.
- 3.Disbanding:** Members prepare to move to new roles or projects.
- 4.Recognition:** Contributions are acknowledged, celebrating accomplishments.



Stage 5
Adjourning

Stage 5 Adjourning

Example:

A cross-functional team was formed to manage the integration of two companies during a merger. After completing the integration plan, harmonizing systems, and meeting key goals, the team enters the adjourning stage:

- Final reports and deliverables are submitted to the leadership.
- A meeting is held to evaluate the success of the merger process, noting areas of strength and improvement.
- Team members return to their respective departments or take on new assignments.

Team Leader Role in the Adjourning Stage

1. Facilitating a Structured Transition:

- Guiding team members as they move to new roles or projects.
- Ensuring a smooth handover of responsibilities if ongoing tasks need to be maintained.

2. Concluding with Reflection:

- Discussing lessons learned and documenting them for future teams or projects.

3. Acknowledging Contributions:

- Celebrating accomplishments through recognition, awards, or informal gatherings.
- Thanking team members individually and collectively for their efforts.

4. Documenting Best Practices:

- Capturing processes, strategies, and tools that worked well for future use.
- Sharing findings with relevant stakeholders to improve organizational learning.

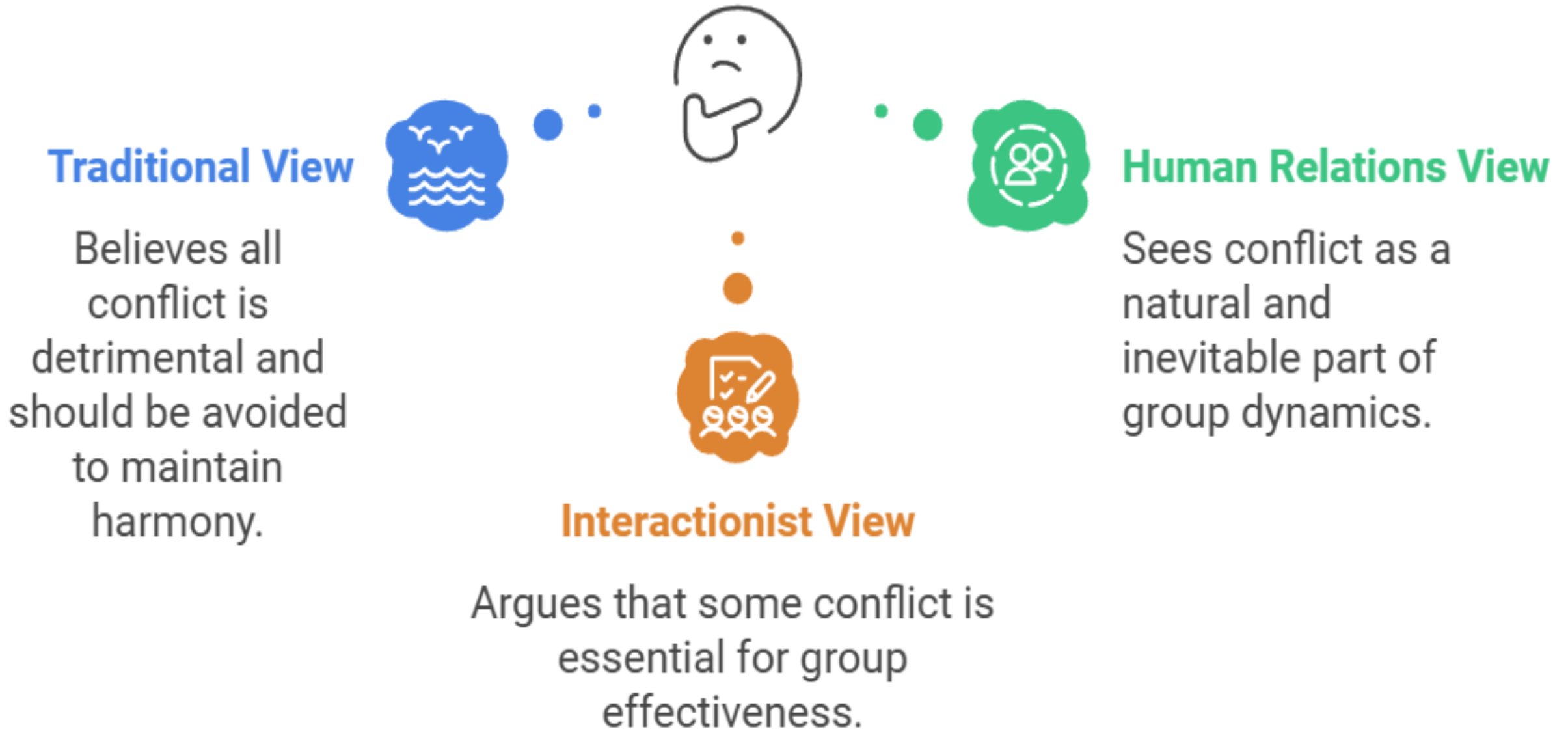
Conflict Management

Conflict

Perceived incompatible differences that result in interference or opposition.

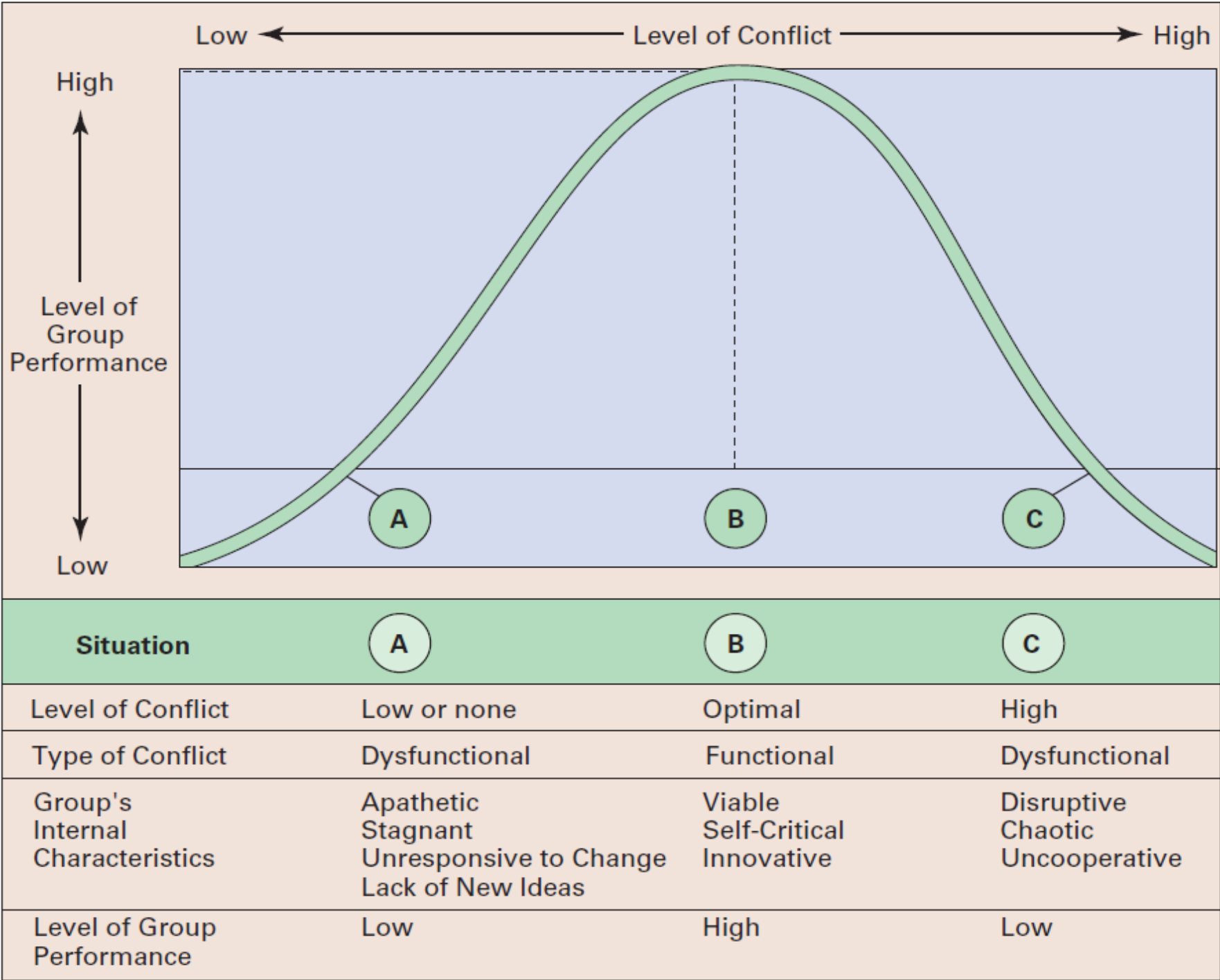


Views of conflict



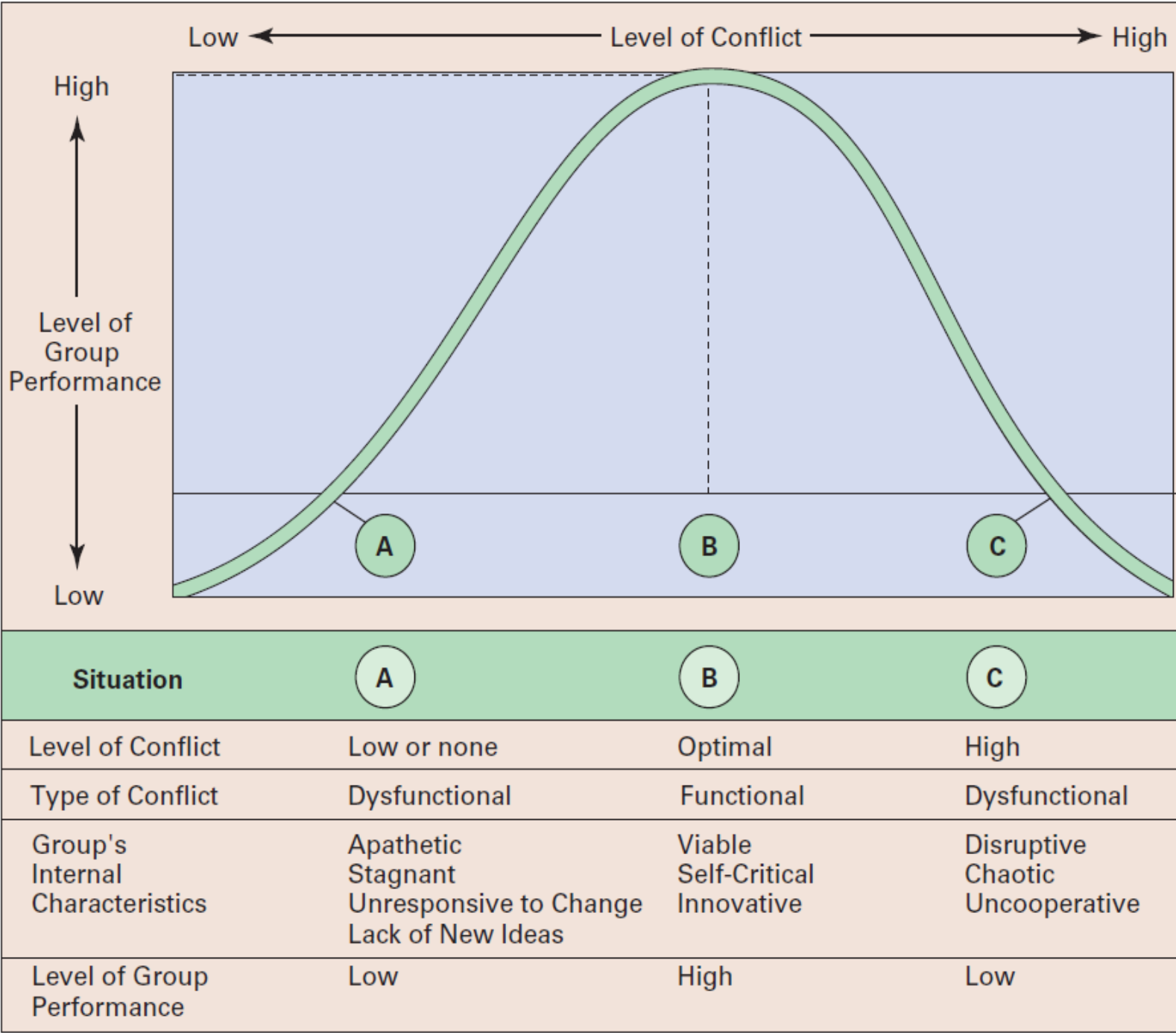
The Model highlights that:

- Too little conflict** can lead to stagnation and low performance.
- An optimal level of conflict** can be beneficial, fostering critical thinking, innovation, and higher performance.
- Too much conflict** can be destructive, leading to chaos, decreased cooperation, and low performance.
- Effective conflict management aims to maintain the level of conflict within the "Optimal" Zone (B) to maximize group performance.
- This involves fostering an environment where constructive disagreement is encouraged while preventing conflict from escalating to dysfunctional levels.



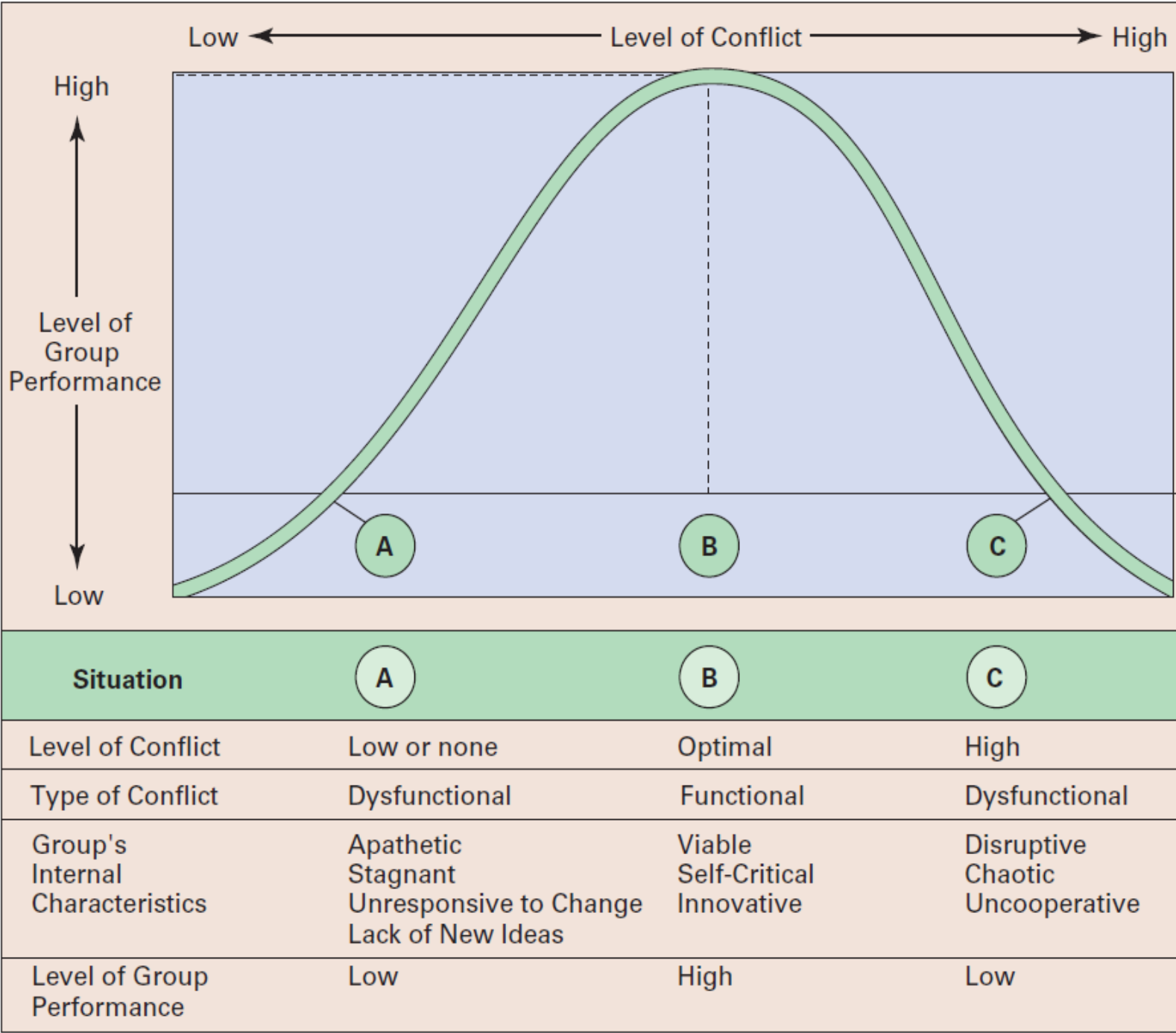
Zone A: Low or No Conflict:

- Level of Conflict:** Low or none.
- Type of Conflict:** Dysfunctional (in this context, due to its absence).
- Group's Internal Characteristics:** Apathetic, stagnant, unresponsive to change, lack of new ideas.
- Level of Group Performance:** Low.
- Explanation:**
 - When there is little to no conflict, the group might become complacent and lack the motivation to critically evaluate ideas or explore new possibilities.
 - This can lead to poor decision-making and low overall performance.



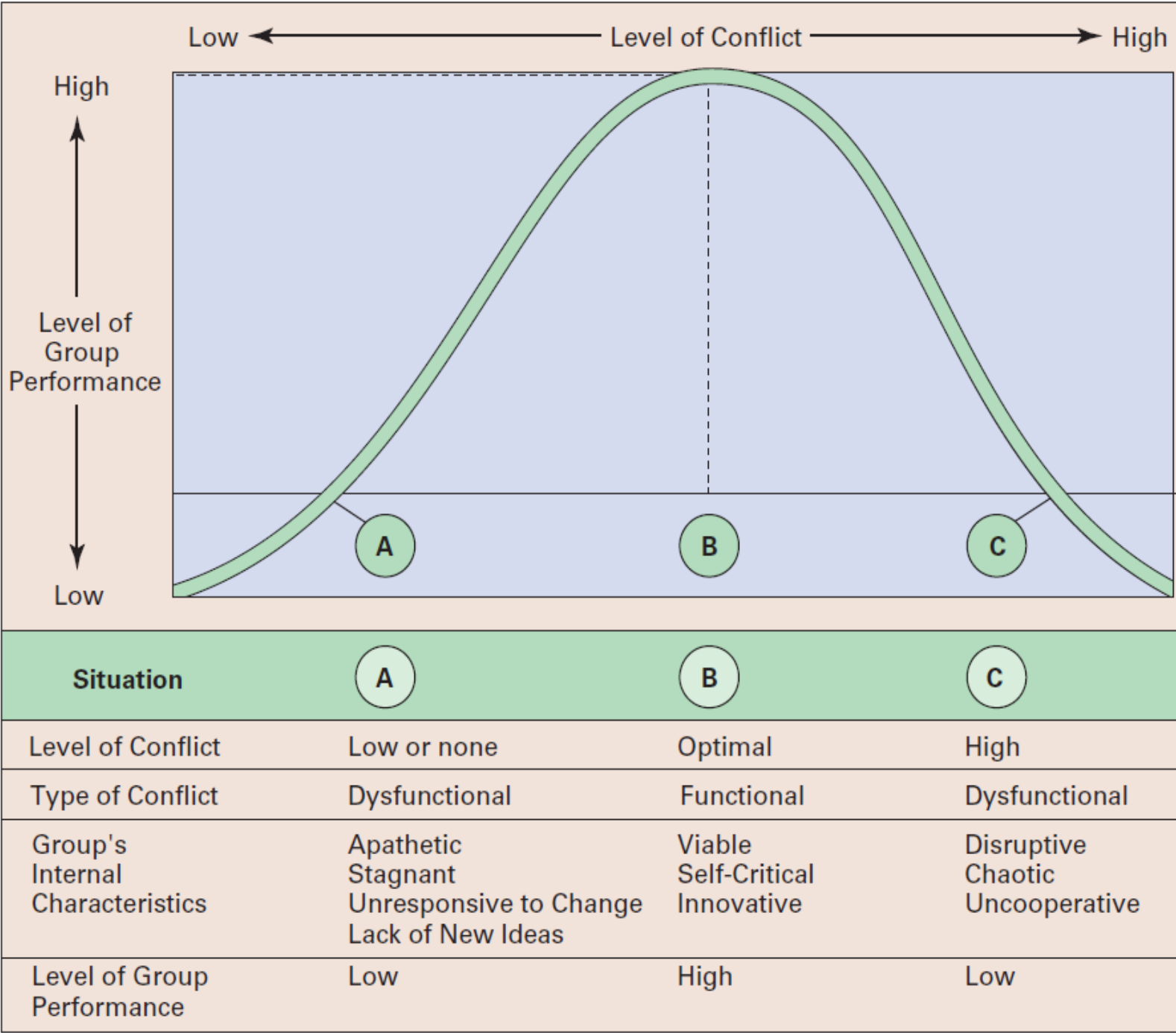
Zone B: Optimal Conflict:

- Level of Conflict:** Optimal.
- Type of Conflict:** Functional.
- Group's Internal Characteristics:** Viable, self-critical, innovative.
- Level of Group Performance:** High.
- Explanation:**
 - This zone represents the sweet spot.
 - A moderate level of conflict can stimulate discussion, encourage the exploration of different perspectives, challenge assumptions, and lead to more creative and effective solutions.
 - Constructive disagreements and debates can prevent groupthink and foster innovation, resulting in high group performance.



Zone C: High Conflict:

- Level of Conflict:** High.
- Type of Conflict:** Dysfunctional.
- Group's Internal Characteristics:**
Disruptive, chaotic, uncooperative.
- Level of Group Performance:** Low.
- Explanation:**
 - When conflict becomes excessive, it can be detrimental to group performance.
 - High levels of conflict can lead to interpersonal clashes, decreased communication, a breakdown of trust, and a focus on winning arguments rather than achieving group goals.
 - This creates a negative and unproductive environment, resulting in low group performance.



Types of Conflicts

Process Conflict

Conflicts over work execution methods.



Functional Conflicts

Conflicts that enhance group goals and performance.



Relationship Conflict

Conflicts based on interpersonal dynamics.



Dysfunctional Conflicts

Conflicts that hinder group goal achievement.



Task Conflict

Conflicts over work content and objectives.



1. Functional Conflicts

Conflicts that **enhance group goals and performance**.

- Positive energy: ideas clash, but the result is better solutions, creativity, and stronger team commitment.
- Usually seen in Task or Process conflicts when handled constructively.
- Hallmarks: Respectful disagreement, diverse viewpoints welcomed, higher innovation.



How to Deal With It

- **Amplify it deliberately:** As leader, model constructive disagreement and reward people who challenge ideas respectfully.
- **Use conflict rituals:** Implement “Pre-Mortem” exercises or “Plus/Delta” feedback rounds.
- **Train the team:** Run short workshops on “Conflict as Fuel” teach psychological safety and debate skills.
- **Monitor the temperature:** Make sure it stays functional (no personal attacks).
- **Goal:** Keep the team in this zone as often as possible — this is where high-performing teams live!

2. Dysfunctional Conflicts

Conflicts that **hinder group goal achievement**.

- Negative energy: personal attacks, avoidance, reduced productivity, gossip, low morale, or even sabotage.
- Usually happens when Relationship Conflict spirals or when Task/Process conflicts are ignored too long.
- Hallmarks: Emotional hijacking, blame culture, disengagement.

How to Deal With It

- **Intervene immediately:** Do not wait — dysfunctional conflict spreads like wildfire.
- **Root-cause analysis:** Privately ask each person: “What outcome do you want here?”
- **Reset the team norms:** Hold a facilitated “Conflict Reset” session with clear ground rules.
- **Escalate when needed:** Involve HR or senior leadership for formal mediation or Performance Improvement Plans.
- **Prevent recurrence:** After resolution, conduct a “lessons learned” debrief and update team agreements.
- **Critical Rule:** Never ignore dysfunctional conflict — it is the #1 killer of team performance.



3. Task Conflicts

Conflicts over **work content and objectives** — what needs to be done, priorities, goals, or the “what” of the project.

- Example: Two team members disagree on whether to focus on feature A or feature B first.
- Usually cognitive (idea-based) rather than emotional.
- Can be healthy when kept professional.



How to Deal With It

- **Encourage healthy debate:** Use structured techniques like “Six Thinking Hats” or Devil’s Advocate rounds.
- **Clarify objectives early:** Run a quick alignment session with the question “What problem are we actually solving?”
- **Facilitate, don’t dictate:** As leader, stay neutral, summarize both sides, then guide the team to data-driven decisions.
- **Outcome goal:** Convert the conflict into better decisions and innovation.

4. Relationship Conflicts

Conflicts based on **interpersonal dynamics** — personalities, values, communication styles, or personal dislikes.

- Example: Tension between two colleagues who simply don't “click” or have clashing egos.

Highly emotional and often the most damaging if left unaddressed.



How to Deal With It

- **Address privately and early:** Use the “I notice... I feel... I need...” script in a 1:1 conversation.
- **Focus on behaviors, not personalities:** Say “I notice the tone in meetings has become sharp” instead of “You’re aggressive.”
- **Mediate with empathy:** Bring both parties together only after individual check-ins; use active listening and mutual respect agreements.
- **Build psychological safety:** Run team-building activities or anonymous feedback rounds to strengthen relationships proactively.
- **When severe:** Consider temporary role separation or, in extreme cases, reassignment.

5. Process Conflicts

Conflicts over **how** the work is executed — methods, procedures, responsibilities, timelines, or resource allocation.

- Example: “Should we use Agile or Waterfall?” or “Who owns the final sign-off?”

Often appears as logistical friction but can quickly turn personal if roles feel unclear.



How to Deal With It

- **Map the process visually:** Use a RACI chart (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) or simple workflow diagram in a 30-minute meeting.
- **Agree on rules of engagement:** Create a short “Team Process Charter” that everyone signs off on.
- **Revisit regularly:** Schedule a 15-minute “Process Check” at the start of each sprint or quarter.
- **Outcome goal:** Remove ambiguity so energy returns to the actual work.

RACI Chart

A **RACI chart** (also called a **RACI matrix** or **Responsibility Assignment Matrix**) is a simple table that clearly defines **who is involved** in each task or deliverable of a project — and **in what capacity**.

It eliminates confusion, reduces overlap, prevents tasks from falling through the cracks, and dramatically lowers unnecessary conflicts.

RACI stands for:

- **R = Responsible** The person(s) who **do the work** they execute the task.

- There can be multiple Rs for one task.

- *Example: The graphic designer who creates the visuals.*

- **A = Accountable** The person who is **ultimately answerable** for the task's success.

- They approve the final work and ensure it meets quality standards.

- **Rule:** There should be **only one A** per task (this is the most important rule).

- *Example: The Marketing Manager who signs off on the final campaign asset.*

- **C = Consulted** People whose **input or opinion is actively sought** before the task is completed.

- They provide feedback or expertise (two-way communication).

- *Example: The Legal team that must review the campaign copy.*

- **I = Informed** People who need to be **kept up-to-date** on progress or the final outcome, but do not need to be involved in the work itself (one-way communication).

- *Example: The CEO who receives a summary report when the campaign launches.*

How to Create a RACI Chart (Step-by-Step)

1- List all key tasks/deliverables (rows)

- Break the project into specific activities or milestones (e.g., “Create campaign brief”, “Design assets”, “Run A/B testing”).

2- List all involved people/roles (columns)

- Include everyone who might touch the project, Project Manager, Team Leads, Stakeholders, etc.

3- Assign R, A, C, or I to each intersection

- Start with the **A** (only one per row).
- Then assign **R** (who actually does it).
- Add **C** and **I** as needed.

4- Review for common problems:

- No **R** → Task has no owner (gap)
- Multiple **As** → Confusion over final ownership
- Too many **Cs** → Decision paralysis
- Empty rows/columns → Missing involvement

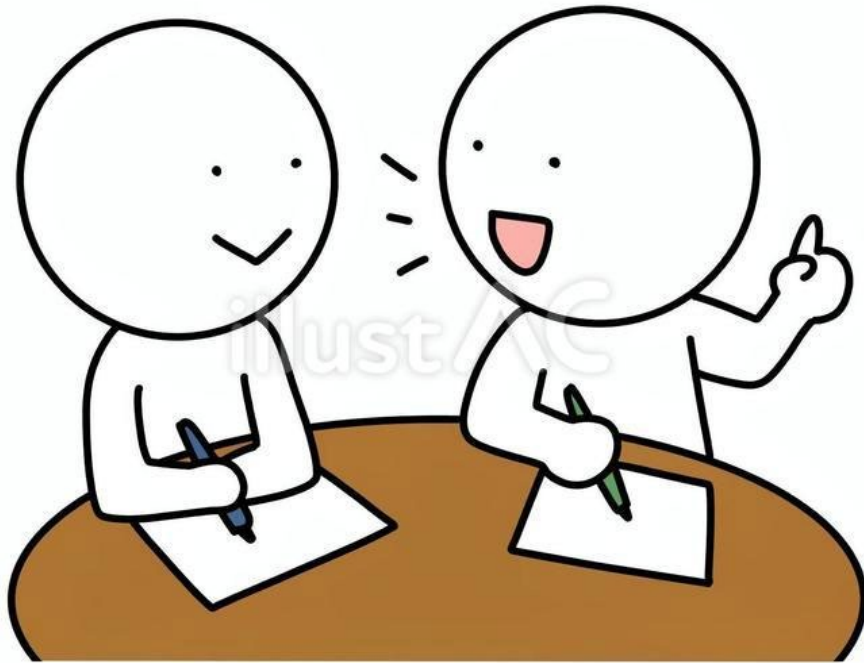
5- Discuss and agree with the team (this step prevents later conflict!)

6- Document, share, and revisit regularly (especially at project checkpoints).

Simple Example: Marketing Campaign RACI

Task	Project Manager	Marketing Lead	Designer	Copywriter	Legal	CEO
Define campaign objectives	A	R	I	C	I	I
Create campaign brief	A	R	C	C	C	I
Design visual assets	I	A	R	C	I	I
Write copy & messaging	I	A	I	R	C	I
Legal & compliance review	I	C	I	C	R/A	I
Launch campaign	A	R	I	I	I	C
Post-launch report	R	A	I	I	I	I

Type	Nature	Typical Emotion	Best Strategy	Desired Outcome
Task Conflict	Content-focused	Cognitive	Structured debate & data	Better decisions
Process Conflict	Method-focused	Logistical	RACI charts & process charters	Clear execution
Relationship Conflict	Personal	Emotional	Private mediation & empathy	Restored trust
Functional	Positive	Energizing	Amplify & train	Innovation & performance
Dysfunctional	Negative	Draining	Immediate intervention & reset	Damage control & recovery



**ACTIVITY
WORKS**



The text 'ACTIVITY WORKS' is rendered in a bold, bubbly font. The letters are primarily red with a thick blue outline and a yellow inner border. The letter 'V' in 'ACTIVITY' and the letter 'O' in 'WORKS' are replaced by blue mechanical gears. Below the word 'WORKS', there are three additional blue gears of varying sizes, some overlapping each other.

What is the most common type of conflict within your organization?



Process Conflict

Conflicts over work execution methods.



Functional Conflicts

Conflicts that enhance group goals and performance.



Relationship Conflict

Conflicts based on interpersonal dynamics.



Dysfunctional Conflicts

Conflicts that hinder group goal achievement.



Task Conflict

Conflicts over work content and objectives.



Talent Grid



Talent Grid

It is a strategic tool used to assess and manage employees in organizations based on their **performance** and **potential**.

It is typically designed as a 3x3 matrix to classify employees into categories.

How to Use the 9-Box Grid Effectively

- **Talent Reviews** : Managers plot their team members in the grid during talent review sessions.
- **Succession Planning**: Identify who can fill key roles in the future (especially the top-right boxes).
- **Development Planning**: Tailor individual development plans based on the box they fall into.
- **Resource Allocation**: Decide where to invest most in coaching, training, promotions, or stretch assignments.

The goal is to make informed decisions regarding promotions and career development.

Matrix Axes:

Horizontal Axis: Performance

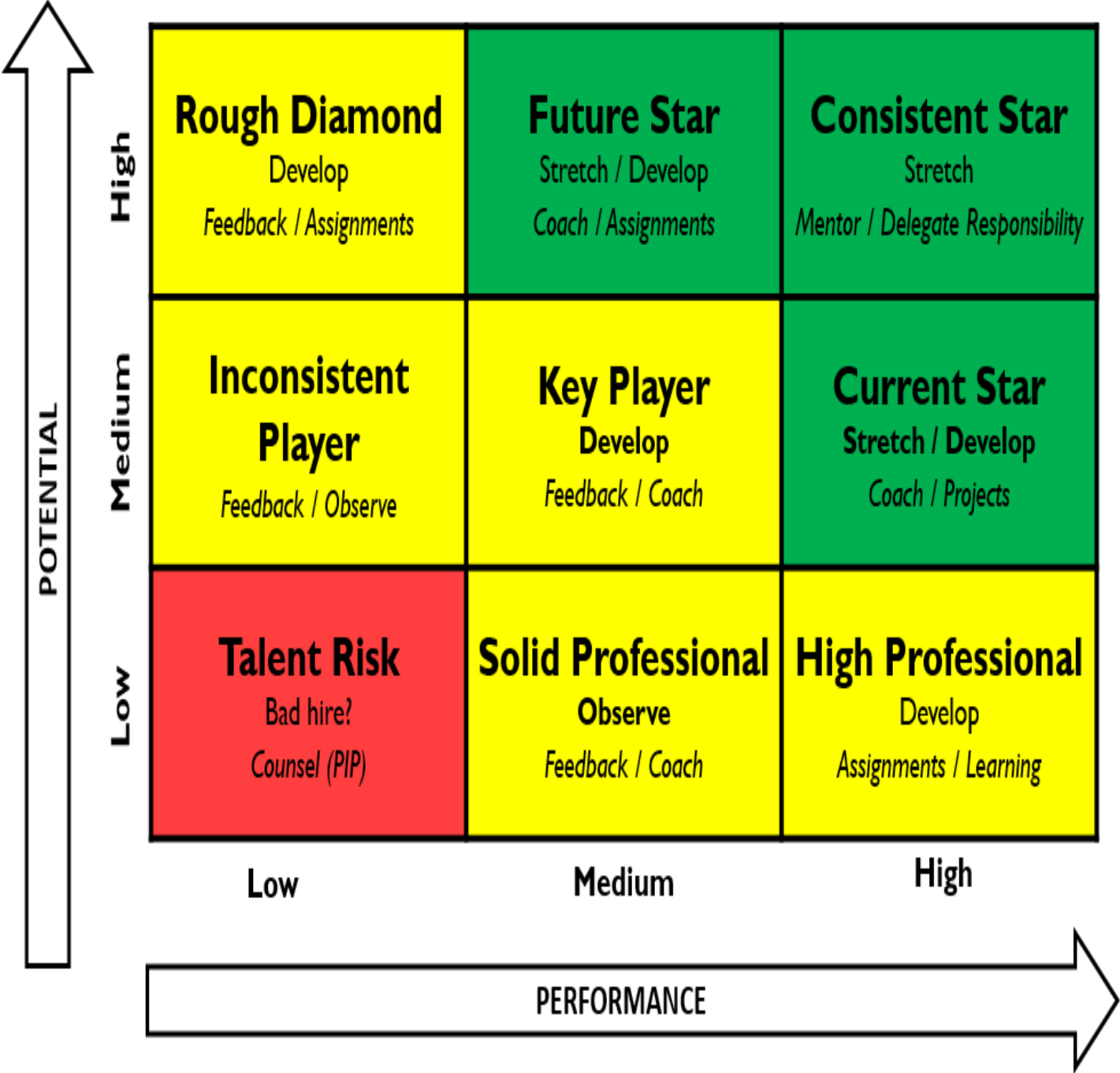
(Employee's success in executing current tasks and achieving required objectives)

- Low:** Performance does not meet expectations.
- Moderate:** Performance generally meets expectations.
- High:** Performance significantly exceeds expectations.

Vertical Axis: Potential

(Employee's ability to grow, develop, acquire new skills, take on leadership roles, and handle greater responsibilities)

- Low:** Limited ability to grow and develop into higher-level roles.
- Moderate:** Good potential for future growth and development.
- High:** Very strong potential to advance and take on senior leadership positions.



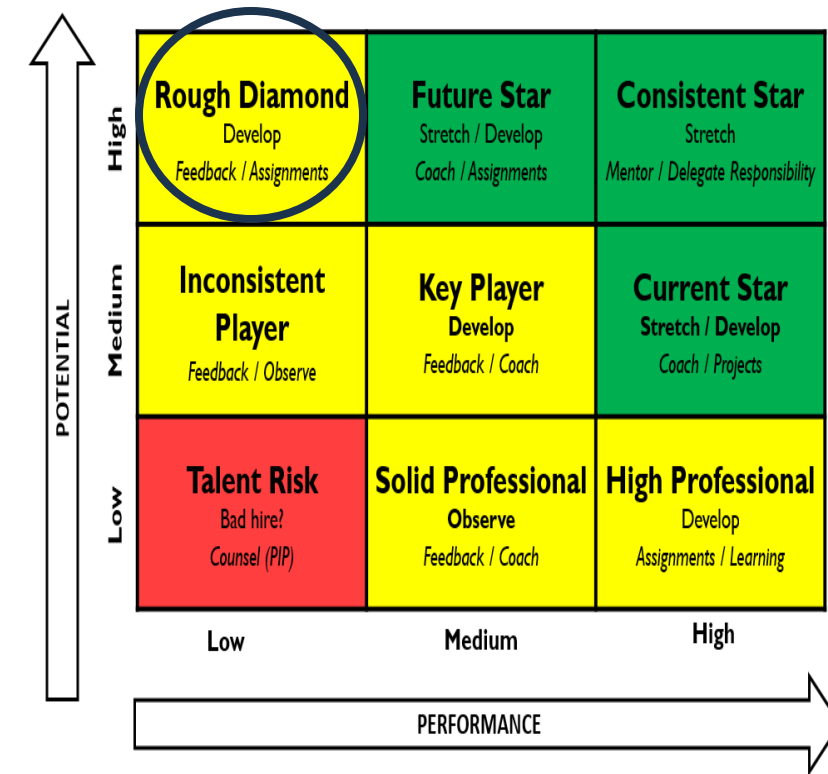
1. Rough Diamond (High Potential / Low Performance)

Characteristics

- Extremely high future capability (quick learner, strategic thinker, strong leadership traits).
- Current performance is low often because they are **new in role**, **lack experience**, **have unclear expectations**, or are in **the wrong seat**.
- They show “spark” in assessments, interviews, or past roles, but results aren’t there yet.
- High energy, creative problem-solvers, but may struggle with execution or confidence.

How to deal with them

- **Heavy investment:** treat them like a high-value project.
- Give frequent, specific feedback and clear assignments to build skills quickly.
- Pair them with a strong coach or mentor. Move them into stretch projects that match their potential.
- Assigning new tasks and challenges to test their abilities.
- **Goal:** Close the performance gap fast so they move rightward into “Future Star” or “Consistent Star.”



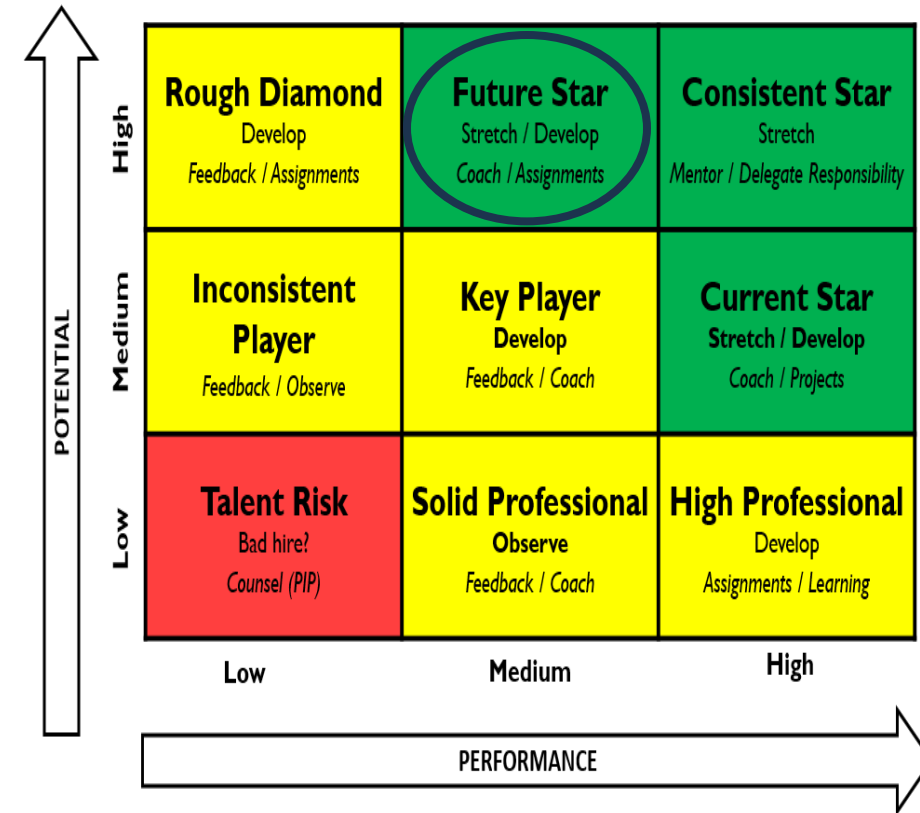
2. Future Star (High Potential / Medium Performance)

Characteristics

- Clear high-potential profile with solid (but not yet outstanding) current results.
- Possesses good basic skills and a positive attitude.
- They are “**almost there**” strong technical skills and growing leadership presence.
- They thrive on challenge and show hunger for growth.
- Usually early or mid-career talent who just needs the right opportunities.

How to deal with them

- **Stretch and accelerate:** give them bigger, more complex assignments.
- Provide dedicated coaching and regular feedback.
- Expose them to senior leaders and cross-functional projects.
- Create a clear development plan with measurable milestones.
- Goal: Push them into the “Consistent Star” box within 12–18 months.



3. Consistent Star (High Potential / High Performance)

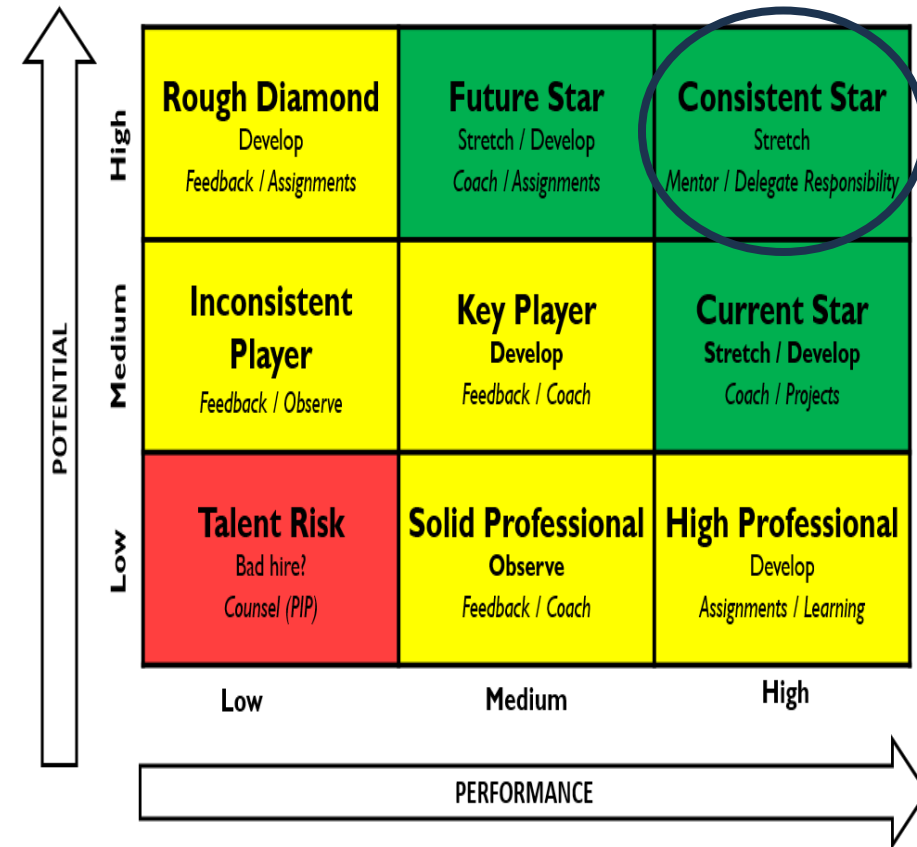
Characteristics

- Your true A-players (top 5–10% of the organization).
- Consistently deliver exceptional results while showing clear ability to take on bigger roles.
- A valuable and reliable member of the team.
- Demonstrates a deep understanding of their role and responsibilities.
- High emotional intelligence, strategic vision, and natural leadership.
- They are ready (or nearly ready) for promotion.

How to deal with them

•Retain and challenge aggressively.

- Giving them greater leadership opportunities to expand the scope of their expertise and responsibilities.
- Turn them into mentors and internal leaders.
- Delegate meaningful ownership so they don't get bored.
- Offer executive coaching or external development programs.
- **Goal:** Keep them engaged and prepare them for the next level (succession pipeline).



4. Inconsistent Player (Medium Potential / Low Performance)

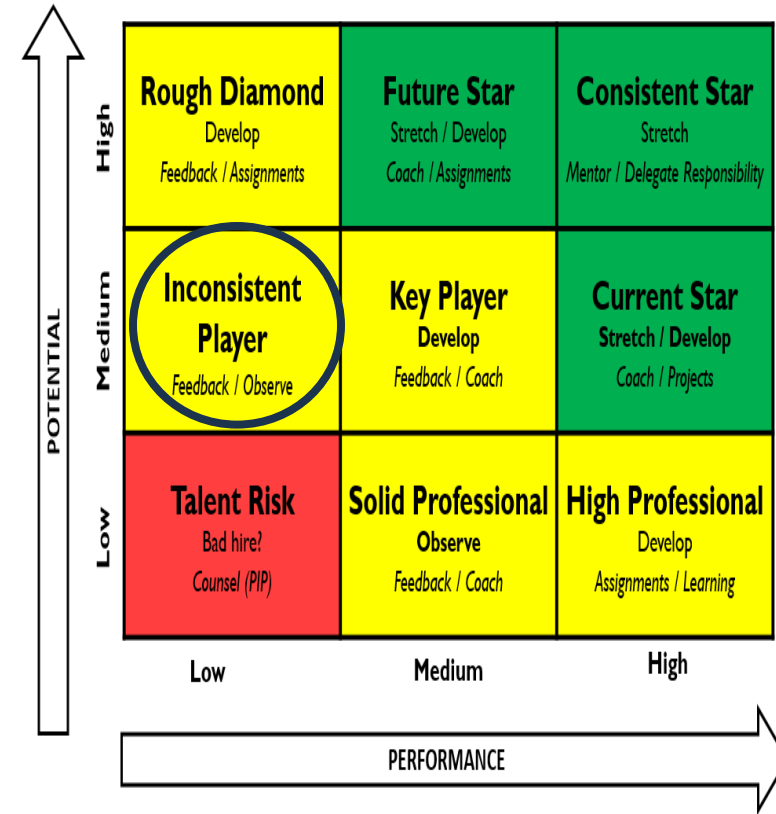
Characteristics

- Performance is inconsistent and unreliable; sometimes good, sometimes bad.
- May possess specific skills but struggles with overall performance or consistency
- Medium potential: they can do the job at a basic level but lack the drive or skills to grow significantly.
- Often caused by lack of motivation, personal problems, unclear goals, or poor fit with the role.

How to deal with them

•Observe closely and give direct feedback.

- Set very clear, short-term performance expectations.
- Have frequent check-ins (weekly or bi-weekly).
- Document everything: this may lead to a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) if no improvement.
- If they do not show consistent improvement, it may be best to re-evaluate their job suitability or transfer them to a role that better suits them.
- **Goal:** Stabilize performance or decide if they belong in a different role/lower box.



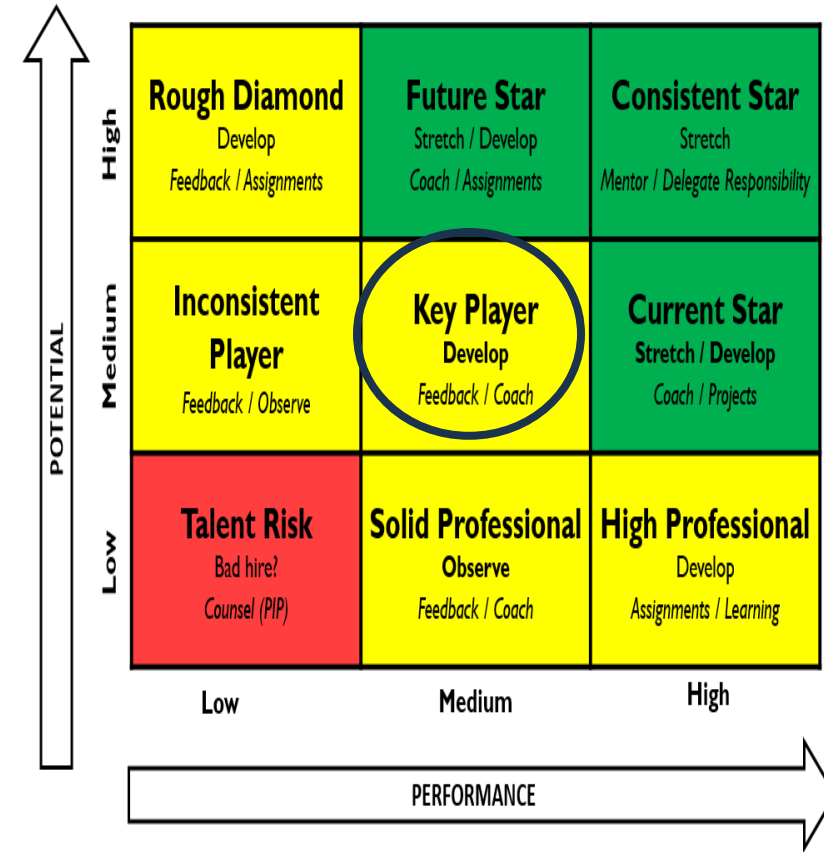
5. Key Player (Medium Potential / Medium Performance)

Characteristics

- Possesses valuable and specialized skills and knowledge in their area of expertise.
- Is often relied upon for specific tasks or projects.
- Performance is generally good when focused on their area of strength.
- May struggle with tasks outside their comfort zone or lack broader skills.
- Medium potential: unlikely to move into senior leadership but valuable in their current scope.

How to deal with them

- **Develop and coach gently.**
- Provide regular feedback focused on consistency and minor skill upgrades.
- Offer targeted training or coaching to raise their ceiling slightly.
- Appreciating their efforts and rewarding them with incentives and benefits to ensure the continuity of their distinguished performance.
- Providing specialized professional development opportunities, such as advanced courses, that enhance their technical skills.
- Leveraging their expertise in training new employees and transferring their knowledge to them.
- Involving them in diverse and challenging new tasks to maintain their enthusiasm and productivity.
- **Goal:** Maintain reliability while gently pushing for incremental improvement.



6. Current Star (Medium Potential / High Performance)

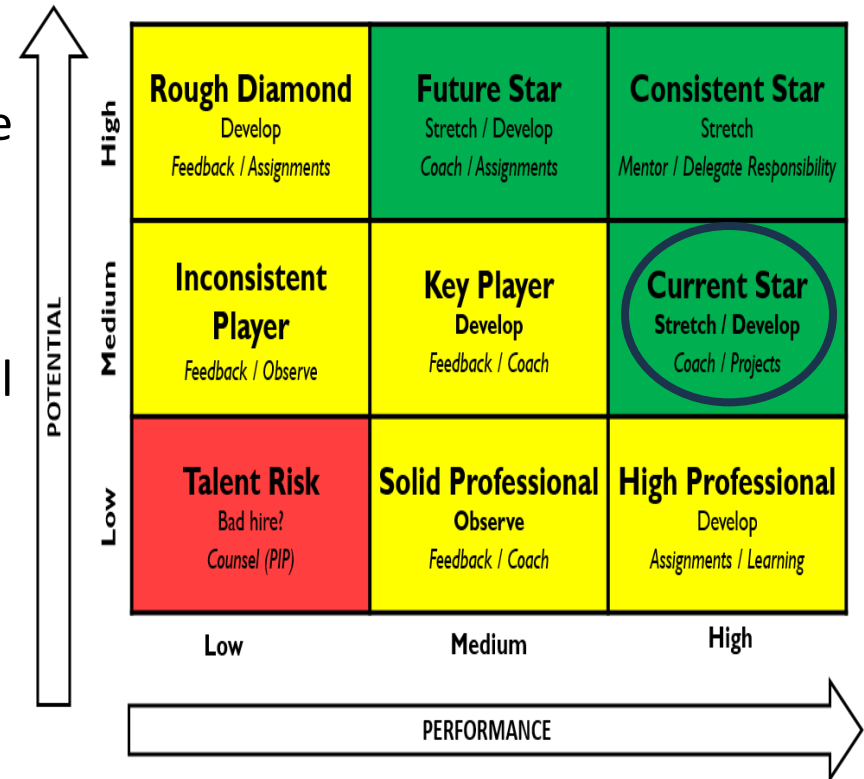
Characteristics

- Excellent performer today: delivers strong results in their current role.
- Highly competent specialists or experienced professionals who love what they do.
- Possesses good skills and experience relevant to their role.
- Demonstrates a solid understanding of their responsibilities.
- May not consistently exceed expectations or show exceptional performance.
- Has the potential for further growth but may lack the drive or opportunity.
- Benefits from ongoing development and opportunities to expand their skills.

How to deal with them

•Maximize and stretch within limits.

- Assign important projects and give them coaching to sustain high performance.
- Encouraging them to share their expertise through mentorship or training new employees.
- Offer lateral growth (new challenges, wider scope) rather than vertical promotion.
- Providing advanced training opportunities to improve their skills and expand the scope of their expertise.
- Motivating them with continuous rewards and appreciation to ensure the continuity of their distinguished performance.
- Granting them suitable additional responsibilities without forcing them into leadership roles that do not suit them.
- **Goal:** Keep them motivated and productive without setting them up for failure at the next level.



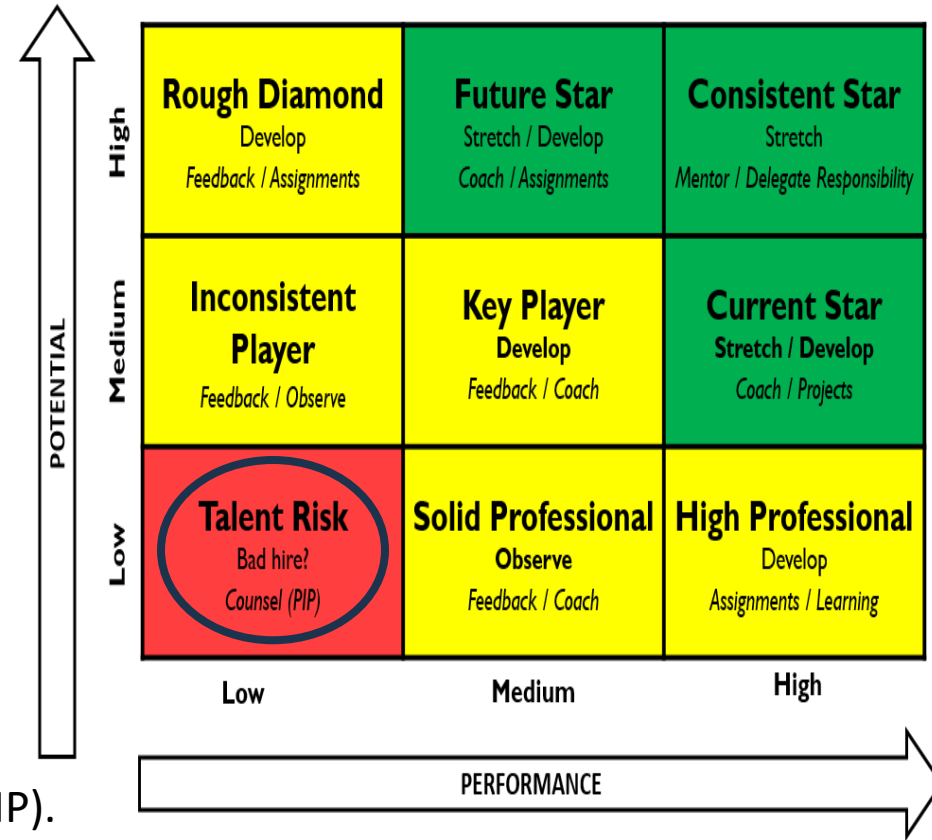
7. Talent Risk (Low Potential / Low Performance)

Characteristics

- Poor current results + very limited future growth potential.
- Performance is often below expectations and requires significant intervention.
- May be a “bad hire,” skill mismatch, attitude problem, or someone who has state of little or no change.
- Often shows low motivation, repeated mistakes, or cultural misfit.
- May lack the necessary aptitude, motivation, or commitment.
- Struggles to meet basic requirements and deadlines.

How to deal with them

- **Act quickly** — this is the “red box.”
 - Start with honest counseling and a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP).
 - Document performance rigorously.
 - Decide within 30–90 days: move to a different (simpler) role or manage out of the organization.
 - Setting clear and measurable goals, with progress monitoring.
 - In case of no improvement, termination or contract termination may be one of the options to ensure the team's efficiency..
- **Goal:** Protect team performance and culture, do not let them stay.



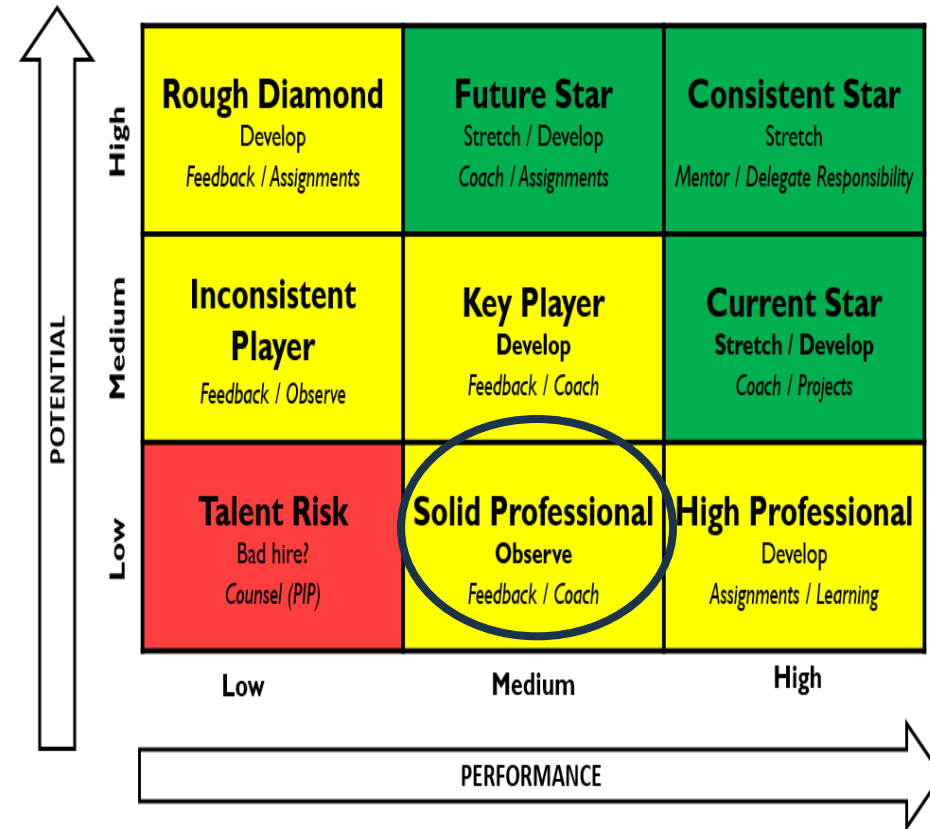
8. Solid Professional (Low Potential / Medium Performance)

Characteristics

- Performance is stable meets basic expectations and reliable but rarely exceeds expectations.
- Possesses the necessary skills and experience to perform adequately.
- Reliable for routine or operational work; low drama.
- Low potential: happy in their current role and unlikely to advance.
- Does not typically seek out new challenges or responsibilities.
- May lack initiative, creativity, or the desire for further development.

How to deal with them

- Observe and maintain.**
- Give regular feedback and light coaching to keep standards steady.
- Offer training to maintain skills (not for promotion).
- Offering suitable professional development opportunities to enhance their skills without assigning them tasks that do not suit them.
- Recognize their contribution to keep morale high.
- Providing continuous rewards and appreciation to maintain their motivation and ensure the continuity of their good performance.
- Goal:** Keep them productive and engaged in their current lane.



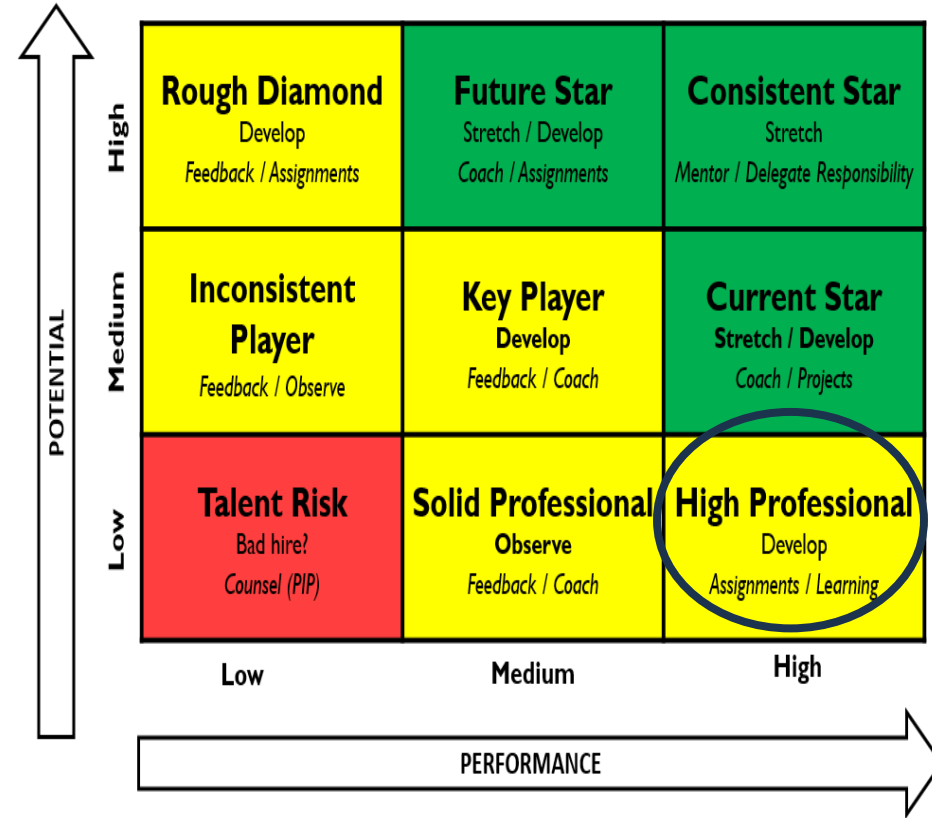
9. High Professional (Low Potential / High Performance)

Characteristics

- Outstanding results in their current role: true expert or top contributor.
- Low potential: they have reached their natural ceiling and are not interested in or suited for bigger roles.
- Is proactive, innovative, and a valuable asset to the organization.
- A highly skilled and experienced professional with a strong track record.
- Consistently delivers exceptional results and sets a high standard for others.
- Demonstrates a strategic mindset and contributes significantly to the organization's goals.

How to deal with them

- **Develop and retain through engagement.**
- Use them as mentors or knowledge experts.
- Give them new assignments, learning opportunities, and variety to prevent boredom.
- Offer recognition, competitive pay, and flexible work arrangements.
- Involving them in strategic projects that benefit from their deep expertise.
- Providing advanced training opportunities to improve their specialized skills and enhance their professional development.
- Leveraging their expertise in training new employees or providing internal consultations.
- **Goal:** Keep their high performance without pushing them into roles they will fail in.



The image features a central white square containing the text "Thank YOU!". The text is written in a dark blue, bold, sans-serif font. The word "Thank" is on the top line, and "YOU!" is on the bottom line. The letters are surrounded by a hand-drawn, wavy red line that forms a loose frame around the text. In the four corners of the overall image, there are decorative geometric shapes. The top-left and bottom-left corners feature overlapping squares in shades of light blue and medium blue. The top-right and bottom-right corners feature overlapping squares in shades of light purple and medium purple.

**Thank
YOU!**